

FEDERAL MINISTRY OF HEALTH & SOCIAL WELFARE

NATIONAL PUBLIC HEALTH EMERGENCY ADVISORY: CHOLERA & WATERBORNE EPIDEMIC PROTOCOL

Reference: FMOH/EPI/2024/09 | Abuja, Nigeria

Target Audience: Primary Healthcare Centres, Traditional Rulers, Market Associations, Community Development Committees.

EPIDEMIOLOGICAL SITUATION:

Surveillance reports indicate severe clusters of acute watery diarrhea and suspected cholera outbreaks across high-density municipal markets and agrarian riverine communities due to contamination of shallow well water during early flash flooding.

MANDATORY DIRECTIVES FOR COMMUNITY ADOPTION:

- 1. Decontamination & Water Purification:** All households must boil borehole and open-well water vigorously for at least 3 minutes before drinking, or treat with certified chlorine Water Guard solution (1 capful per 25-litre container).
- 2. Market Food Safety:** Ban roadside hawking of unwashed sliced fruits (watermelons, pineapples) and raw vegetables without portable running water stations.
- 3. Immediate Oral Rehydration (ORT):** Immediately administer homemade ORS (1 level teaspoon of salt + 6 level teaspoons of sugar in 1 litre of clean boiled water) at the first onset of symptoms while evacuating the patient to the nearest primary health centre.

Signed:

Directorate of Public Health & Disease Surveillance
Federal Ministry of Health & Social Welfare, Nigeria